

SAFETY DOCUMENTATION — SAMPLE

Emergency Evacuation Procedure

SOP ID SOP-EM-204	DEPARTMENT Facilities & Safety	EFFECTIVE DATE July 1, 2026	REVIEW CYCLE Annual
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Purpose

This procedure establishes the steps employees and designated personnel must follow to safely and efficiently evacuate the building during a fire, severe weather event, security threat, or other emergency requiring immediate evacuation.

Scope

This procedure applies to all employees, contractors, and visitors present in the facility at the time of an emergency, regardless of department, shift, or floor location.

Important
Always treat every alarm as a real emergency. Never assume an alarm is a drill or test unless explicitly confirmed by a Floor Warden or the Safety Officer.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Floor Warden	Directs occupants to the nearest safe exit, sweeps assigned area, and reports an all-clear status to the Safety Officer.
Employees	Stop work immediately, follow Floor Warden instructions, and proceed to the designated assembly point.
Safety Officer	Confirms the building is fully evacuated, liaises with emergency responders, and authorizes re-entry.
Front Desk / Reception	Notifies emergency services if not already automatically alerted and accounts for visitor sign-in logs.

Procedure

1. Upon Hearing the Alarm

1. Stop all work activity immediately.
2. Leave personal belongings behind; do not stop to collect items.
3. Close (but do not lock) doors and office windows if it is safe to do so.
4. Proceed calmly to the nearest marked exit or stairwell.

2. During Evacuation

1. Do not use elevators under any circumstances.
2. Walk, do not run, and keep to the right in stairwells to allow emergency responders to pass.
3. Assist colleagues with disabilities or mobility limitations, or notify a Floor Warden of their location for priority assistance.
4. Follow Floor Warden instructions and posted evacuation route signage at all times.

3. At the Assembly Point

1. Proceed directly to your department's designated assembly point (see Evacuation Routes & Assembly Points).
2. Check in with your Floor Warden so headcount can be confirmed.
3. Remain at the assembly point until the Safety Officer announces an all-clear or directs further action.
4. Do not re-enter the building until authorized, even if the alarm stops sounding.

Evacuation Routes & Assembly Points

Primary and secondary evacuation routes are posted on every floor near elevators and stairwells. Designated assembly points are:

- Primary: North parking lot, near the main entrance flagpole
- Secondary (if primary is inaccessible): South lot, adjacent to Building C

Department-specific maps with the nearest exit highlighted are available from your Floor Warden and posted in each break room.

Special Considerations

- **Employees with disabilities:** Pre-identified individuals are paired with an evacuation buddy. If evacuation is not possible, shelter in the nearest stairwell landing (an Area of Refuge) and notify the Floor Warden of the exact location.
- **Visitors and contractors:** Hosts are responsible for guiding their visitors to the nearest exit and including them in the assembly point headcount.
- **Severe weather events:** Follow shelter-in-place guidance instead of evacuating; move to interior, windowless rooms on the lowest available floor.

Prohibited Actions

- Do not use elevators during an evacuation.
- Do not stop to gather personal belongings.
- Do not re-enter the building until the Safety Officer issues an all-clear.

- Do not block exits, stairwells, or assembly points with vehicles or equipment.

Related Documents

- Fire Safety & Extinguisher Use Policy
- Shelter-in-Place Procedure
- Floor Warden Training Guide
- Visitor Sign-In and Accountability Policy

Document Control

Version	Date	Summary of Change	Approved By
1.0	Jan 2025	Initial release	Safety Officer
2.0	July 2026	Added severe weather and accessibility guidance	Safety Officer